The Guardian

one stop english

How to quit fast fashion: 'Sometimes we don't need retail therapy, we need actual therapy'

Level 3: Advanced – Teacher's notes

Article summary: The article describes how four different people have quit fast fashion and encourages the reader to follow in their footsteps.

Time: 60 minutes

Skills: Reading, Speaking, Writing

Language focus: Vocabulary (collocations)

Materials needed: One copy of the worksheet per student

1. Warmer

a. You can first elicit the meaning of the three terms and then get students to check the definitions. The purpose of this activity is to introduce the topic of fast fashion and to get students thinking about their relationship to it as well as its impact on the environment.

2. Key words

a. Ask students to do the exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs or small groups. You can get students to provide synonyms and ask them which words are more formal. E.g., *aesthetics* is more formal than *appearance* or *style*; *craving* is more informal and less literary than *desire*; *ditch* is less formal than *quit*; *engage* is more formal than *take part in*; *hot* is very informal, much more so than *attractive*; *buy* is less formal than *purchase*; *peddle* is not a commonly used word; *reform* is more formal than *change*.

Key:

1. *gratification*
2. *ditch*
3. *peddle*
4. *conscious*
5. *hot*
6. *craving*
7. *pivotal*
8. *ethics*
9. *impulse purchase*
10. *aesthetics*
11. *engage*
12. *reform*

b. Students complete the sentences using words from task a.

Key:

1. *peddled*
2. *conscious*
3. *ditch*
4. *pivotal*
5. *impulse purchase*
6. *ditch*
7. *reform*
8. *ethics*

3. Comprehension check

a. You can extend this activity by asking students to underline or highlight the sections of each paragraph that helped them find the answers.

Key:

1. *Wendy Syfret*
2. *Maggie Zhou*
3. *Chris Cheers*
4. *Nico Idour*
5. *Chris Cheers*
6. *Nico Idour*
7. *Maggie Zhou*
8. *Lauren Bravo*
9. *Wendy Syfret*
10. *Lauren Bravo*

4. Key language

a. Students could be asked to do this exercise individually and then compare their answers in pairs. The answers given are the phrases used in the text.

Key:

1. *delay gratification*
2. *browse a site*
3. *peddle a promise*
4. *satisfy a craving*
5. *adhere to principles*
6. *make a conscious effort / make impulse purchases*
7. *reform shopping habits*
8. *minimise environmental impact*
9. *make a conscious effort / make impulse purchases*
10. *shop second-hand*

b. Ask students to work individually or in pairs and choose five collocations they want to learn and remember. Have them write a question with each of their chosen collocations. Then regroup students so they work in new pairs or groups and take turns to ask and answer their questions. Encourage them to pay attention to the other students' answers and check that they are using the collocations correctly.

5. Discussion

a. Allow students time to note down their ideas about each statement and encourage them to say why they agree or disagree with each one.

6. In your own words

a. The task could also be done as a homework task and students could then email each other (and you).

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